

Why I Never Close Emacs

Emacs is an extensible text editor built on top of the LISP programming language. It has an extensive command library, which can be built into macros that can perform different automated tasks. In this article, the author discusses the various uses of Emacs, which include editing, backing up and browsing.



I once complained to my friend about the desktop on his computer, which was cluttered with icons. "It's easier this way," he chuckled, adding, "I can quickly find all the software I need." I then showed him my desktop, which was spick and span. "Doesn't it take time to find the software you need?" he asked. I told him I had all the software I needed on my desktop. He looked at my screen and found a single Emacs icon. "You use just one software?" he asked. "Mostly, yes," I said. "What about editing, browsing, music, etc?" he asked. "I do it all in Emacs," I quipped and I explained to him why Emacs is informally called a complete operating system and why I never close it.

Emacs is not meant to be an all-in-one substitute for all software since, of course, some software is better at

doing specific tasks. This article demonstrates the power and versatility of Emacs.



Note: For those unfamiliar with Emacs, the key abbreviations used are:

1. *M - x*: hold the meta key (usually Esc) and *x*
2. *C*: Control
3. *S*: Shift
4. *C-x f--*: hold both *Control* and *x*, release both, and press *f*

Emacs for editing

Emacs is a 'mode less' editor, which means that unlike other powerful editors like Vim, you can start inserting text as soon as you open it. This is one of the reasons why it is popular